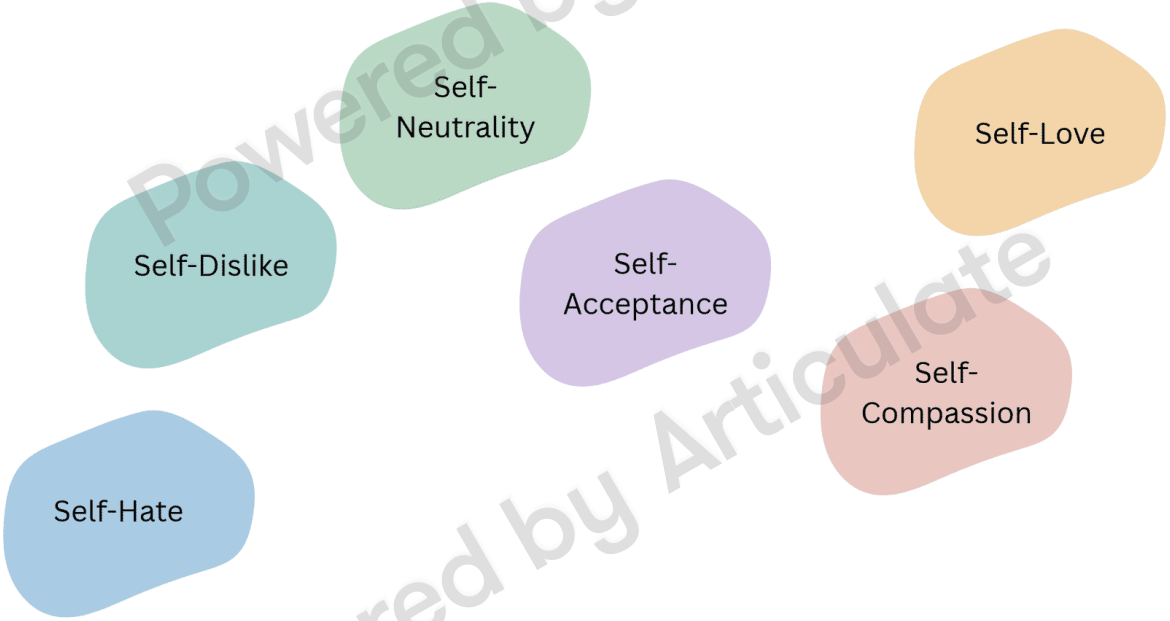
SK Stephanie Kepley

Path to Self-Love

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Self-Hate —

Extreme disdain for oneself.

Example: "I am not good enough or worthy of respect."

Self-Dislike/Self-Awareness

Examining thoughts, actions, and emotions in relation to personal standards.

Example: "Maybe I'm not so bad. My voice matters."

Self-Neutrality

The ability to see yourself objectively.

Example: "I am human and deserve the same regard as others."

Self-Acceptance

Accepting yourself without conditions and seeing your whole self rather than focusing on individual defects.

Example: "I can boldly and unapologetically take up space."

Self-Compassion

Treating yourself with kindness, patience, and understanding, especially when facing mistakes, setbacks, or difficult emotions.

Example: "I am good enough."

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Self-Love —

Appreciation and respect for yourself.

Example: "I am worthy."

CONTINUE

Self-Hate: You Can't Hate Yourself Into Something You Love

Self-hate can create the belief that if we punish ourselves long enough, we'll eventually become someone worthy of forgiveness. But self-punishment isn't the same as self-growth.

Moving forward begins with a different question: **Who am I really?**

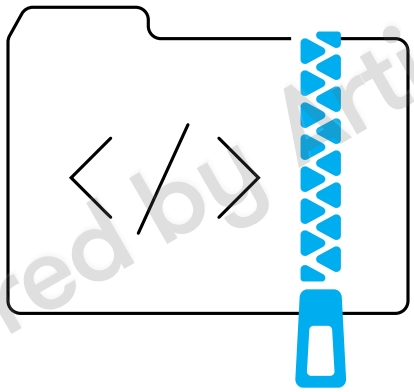
Who Am I Really?

❤️ What do I care about?

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💪 What are my values, beliefs, strengths, and weaknesses?

🎯 How can my strengths help me solve current problems?



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CONTINUE

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Self-Dislike/Self-Awareness: Recognizing What Needs to Change

Becoming more aware of yourself means noticing the connection between what you think, how you feel, and what you do. Sometimes our behaviors reflect our values. Other times, old beliefs, habits, and patterns pull us in a different direction.

Self-Awareness isn't about finding more reasons to criticize yourself. It's about recognizing patterns so you can make different choices.

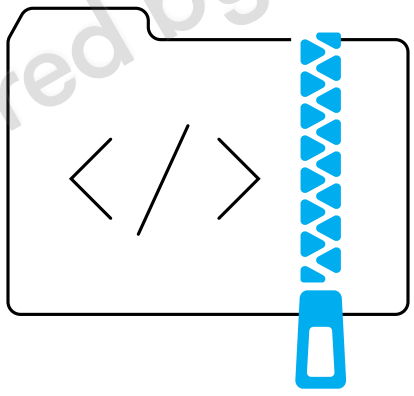
Ask Yourself: *Are my words, thoughts, and behaviors in line with my values? If not, how do I make them so?*

Let Go of Limiting Beliefs

Limiting beliefs are thoughts or assumptions about ourselves, other people, or the world that can hold us back. They often develop through life experiences and become so familiar that we begin treating them as facts.

The more strongly we believe something, the more likely we are to notice evidence that supports it - even when the belief isn't entirely accurate.

The goal isn't to force yourself to think positively. It's to question whether an old belief is helping you grow or keeping you stuck.



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CONTINUE

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Overcoming Self-Sabotaging Behavior

Self-sabotaging behaviors are habits or actions that undermine our goals, efforts, or personal values. These behaviors are often rooted in anxiety, anger, or feelings of worthlessness. Negative self-talk can reinforce these patterns, making it easier to justify choices that work against what we want for ourselves.

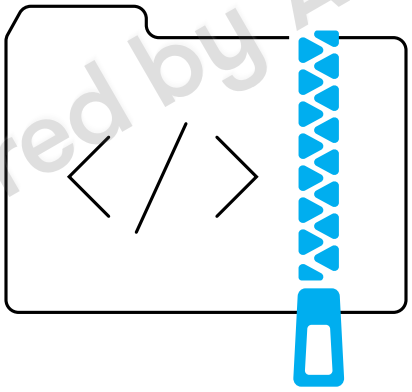
- Procrastinating or repeatedly missing deadlines
- Arriving late to work or important meetings
- Using alcohol or drugs to cope with difficult emotions
- Overeating in response to stress or anxiety
- Starting projects but never finishing them
- Avoiding decisions or actions related to personal goals
- Intentionally damaging friendships or romantic relationships
- Giving up when working toward something important

Recognizing Your Own Patterns

Self-sabotage doesn't always look obvious. Sometimes it shows up in the goals we keep postponing, the decisions we avoid, or the ways we respond to uncomfortable emotions. Recognizing these patterns helps us understand what may be getting in our way.

Reflection: Where Does Self-Sabotage Show Up?

Consider the following questions. The goal isn't to criticize yourself, but to recognize patterns that may be keeping you from moving toward the life you want.



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What is Self-Sabotage Doing for You?

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UNDERSTAND THE NEED | PLAN FOR OBSTACLES | TOLERATE DISCOMFORT | CLARIFY YOUR VALUES

Even when a behavior creates problems, it may serve a purpose in the moment. Procrastination might temporarily relieve anxiety. Withdrawing from relationships might protect us from rejection. Giving up on a goal might reduce the fear of failure.

Understanding what a behavior does for us doesn't mean excusing it. It helps us identify the need we're trying to meet so we can find healthier ways to meet it.

Ask yourself: *What am I getting from this behavior right now, and what is it costing me in the long run?*

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UNDERSTAND THE NEED | PLAN FOR OBSTACLES | TOLERATE DISCOMFORT | CLARIFY YOUR VALUES

It's easy to have good intentions when things are going well. The real challenge comes when we're stressed, overwhelmed, or upset.

Planning ahead helps us recognize situations that might trigger old habits and decide how we want to respond before we're in the middle of them.

Ask yourself: *What situations make me more likely to fall into self-sabotaging patterns, and what could I do differently when they arise?*

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UNDERSTAND THE NEED | PLAN FOR OBSTACLES | TOLERATE DISCOMFORT | CLARIFY YOUR VALUES

Difficult emotions are a normal part of life, but sometimes we respond to them in ways that create additional problems. Avoidance, distraction, and impulsive behaviors may provide temporary relief without addressing what we're experiencing.

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Learning to tolerate emotional discomfort means allowing ourselves to experience difficult feelings without immediately trying to escape or change them. We can acknowledge an emotion without letting it determine our behavior.

Ask yourself: *What emotions tend to trigger my self-sabotaging behaviors, and how could I practice sitting with those feelings instead of reacting to them?*

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Our values represent what matters most to us and the kind of person we want to be. When our behaviors don't align with those values, we may experience frustration, guilt, or dissatisfaction.

Clarifying our values helps us make intentional choices. The more specific we are about what matters to us, the easier it becomes to recognize actions that support our goals rather than undermine them.

For example, instead of simply saying, "I want to be healthier," we might identify a specific goal, such as improving our endurance enough to complete a 10K.

Ask yourself: What values are most important to me, and what is one specific action I could take to live more consistently with them?

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Changing the Way You Talk to Yourself

The way we talk to ourselves is often influenced by beliefs we've developed through past experiences. Over time, negative self-talk can become so familiar that we accept it as fact without questioning it. Learning to recognize these thoughts gives us an opportunity to examine whether they're accurate, helpful, or consistent with the person we want to become.

Questioning Your Inner Critic

Think about something negative you've recently said to yourself

- Where might this belief have come from?
- Is it based on facts, assumptions, or past experiences?
- What evidence supports or challenges this belief?
- What could you say to yourself that is both truthful and encouraging?

If you can't say...
"I love my body."

Try saying...
"My body gets me from place to place."

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If you can't say...
"I'm beautiful."

Try saying...
"I'm a person."

If you can't say...
"I'm valuable."

Try saying...
"All people deserve basic respect, and I am a person."

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If you can't say...
"I'm important" or *"I'm kind."*

Try saying...
"I am someone who does positive things, however small."

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Reflection: Finding a Different Way to Talk to Yourself

Think of three negative thoughts you frequently have about yourself. For each one, consider what you could say instead.

Your replacement statements don't have to be overwhelmingly positive. Focus on finding words that are **realistic, balanced, and compassionate – even if you're not fully ready to believe them yet.**

Remember: The goal isn't to convince yourself that everything is wonderful. It's to practice speaking to yourself without unnecessary criticism.

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CONTINUE

Self-Neutrality: Learning to See Yourself Objectively

Self-neutrality means learning to see ourselves as human beings without constantly assigning positive or negative judgments about who we are. We can recognize our strengths and shortcomings without allowing either to define our entire identity. We don't have to love everything about ourselves to acknowledge that we deserve the same basic respect and consideration as anyone else.

Learning to Forgive Yourself

Self-forgiveness doesn't mean pretending we haven't made mistakes, excusing harmful behavior, or avoiding responsibility. It means acknowledging what happened, taking responsibility for our actions, and recognizing that our mistakes don't have to define who we are.

We can learn from our past without continuing to punish ourselves for it. Forgiving ourselves allows us to move forward while still honoring the lessons we've learned.

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Six Steps to Seeking Forgiveness

Forgiveness is a process, not a single decision. These six steps offer a way to acknowledge what happened, take responsibility, and begin moving forward. You may need to revisit certain steps, and that's okay. The goal isn't perfection - it's progress.

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Step 1

Acknowledge What You Did



Self-forgiveness begins with honestly acknowledging what happened. Identify the behavior or decision you regret without minimizing it, making excuses, or turning one mistake into a judgment about your entire identity.

Ask yourself: *What did I do, and what am I willing to acknowledge about it?*

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Step 2

Understand the Pain You Caused



Acknowledging our actions is only the beginning. Self-forgiveness also involves recognizing how our choices may have affected others, ourselves, or our relationships.

Understanding the impact of our behavior helps us develop empathy and take meaningful responsibility without becoming trapped in shame.

Ask yourself: *Who was affected by my actions, and what might their experience have been?*

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Step 3

Take Responsibility for Your Actions



Taking responsibility means recognizing that our choices have consequences and acknowledging our role in what happened. We can consider the circumstances that influenced our behavior without using them to excuse it.

Accountability isn't about endlessly punishing ourselves. It's about identifying what we can learn, what we can change, and how we can make different choices moving forward.

Ask yourself: *What part of this situation is mine to take responsibility for, and what can I do differently in the future?*

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Step 4

Commit to Meaningful Change



Recognizing our mistakes is important, but meaningful change requires more than good intentions. Seeking forgiveness involves examining the thoughts, attitudes, and behaviors that contributed to our actions and making a commitment to respond differently in the future.

Change doesn't mean we'll never make another mistake. It means we're willing to learn from our experiences, practice healthier responses, and demonstrate growth through our choices.

Ask yourself: *What needs to change in my thinking or behavior, and what specific actions can I take to demonstrate that change?*

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Step 5

Apologize and Ask for Forgiveness



A sincere apology acknowledges the harm we've caused without making excuses or shifting blame. It communicates genuine remorse and demonstrates a willingness to make amends when possible.

Asking for forgiveness requires vulnerability, but it also requires respecting the other person's feelings and boundaries. We cannot control whether someone forgives us, how they respond, or how long their healing takes.

Remember that making amends isn't always possible or appropriate. Sometimes the most meaningful apology is demonstrated through changed behavior rather than direct contact.

Ask yourself: *What would a sincere apology or meaningful act of accountability look like in this situation?*

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Step 6

Forgive Yourself



Self-forgiveness means allowing yourself to move forward without continuing to punish yourself for past mistakes. It doesn't erase what happened, excuse harmful behavior, or eliminate the responsibility to make things right.

Instead, it means recognizing that you are more than your worst decisions. You can acknowledge the harm you've caused, learn from your experiences, and choose to treat yourself with the same compassion you would extend to someone else who is genuinely trying to grow.

Forgiving yourself may take time. You might need to revisit feelings of guilt, regret, or shame along the way. Healing doesn't require forgetting the past; it requires learning to carry it differently.

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Ask yourself: *What would it look like to take responsibility for my past without allowing it to define my future?*

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Moving Forward with Self-Forgiveness

Forgiveness is not about pretending the past didn't happen. It's about acknowledging our actions, understanding their impact, taking responsibility, committing to change, and making amends when possible.

Self-forgiveness is the final step, but it isn't necessarily the easiest. You may revisit these steps as you continue learning and growing.

Remember that **you can hold yourself accountable without holding yourself hostage to the past.**

Final Reflection: *What is one thing you're ready to stop holding against yourself, and what would taking a step toward forgiveness look like?*

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But How Do I Actually Forgive Myself?

Understanding self-forgiveness and actually practicing it are two different things.

You might recognize your mistakes, take responsibility, and commit to change while still struggling with guilt, regret, or resentment toward yourself.

So you do you begin forgiving yourself when you don't *feel* forgiven?

You don't have to fake forgiveness to begin practicing it.

Self-forgiveness isn't about forcing yourself to feel differently. It's about learning to respond to yourself differently, even when difficult feelings remain.

The following six practices can help you begin that process.

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ACKNOWLEDGE YOUR FEELINGS | SET REALISTIC EXPECTATIONS | LET GO OF SELF-PUNISHMENT | RELEASE BLAME & RESENTMENT

Before you can begin forgiving yourself, you need to acknowledge what you're feeling.

You may experience guilt, shame, anger, sadness, or disappointment about your past choices. These emotions can be uncomfortable, but ignoring or suppressing them doesn't make them disappear.

Allow yourself to recognize these feelings without judging yourself for having them. Remember that acknowledging an emotion doesn't mean you have to act on it or allow it to define you.

Ask yourself: *Looking at the Emution Wheel below, which emotions best describe how you feel toward yourself right now? Can you acknowledge those feelings without adding more judgment?*



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ACKNOWLEDGE YOUR FEELINGS | SET REALISTIC EXPECTATIONS | LET GO OF SELF-PUNISHMENT | RELEASE BLAME & RESENTMENT

Forgiving yourself doesn't mean abandoning your standards or pretending your choices don't matter. It means developing realistic expectations for how you'll move forward.

Consider what you've learned from your experience and what you wan to do differently. Focus on specific behaviors you can change rather than demanding perfection from yourself.

Remember that growth involves practice, and making another mistake doesn't erase the progress you've already made.

Ask yourself: *What expectations can I set for myself moving forward that encourage accountability and growth without demanding perfection?*

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Sometimes, when we feel guilty about our mistakes, we believe we deserve to suffer for them. We may replay painful memories, deny ourselves happiness, or engage in self-sabotaging behaviors because we feel we haven't earned the right to move forward.

But **punishing yourself isn't the same as holding yourself accountable.**

Accountability encourages learning and change. Self-punishment keeps us trapped in the past without necessarily helping us grow.

Letting go of self-punishment doesn't mean forgetting what happened. It means recognizing that continued suffering isn't required to demonstrate genuine remorse.

Ask yourself: *In what ways might I be punishing myself for past mistakes, and what would accountability look like without that punishment?*

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Taking responsibility for your mistakes doesn't mean you have to continue defining yourself by them.

Sometimes, we hold on to resentment toward ourselves because we believe letting it go would mean excusing what happened. We may repeatedly criticize ourselves, dwell on what we should have done differently, or allow past decisions to shape how we see ourselves today.

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You can acknowledge that you made a poor choice without deciding that you are a bad person.

Releasing resentment means learning to separate what you did from who you are. You can accept responsibility for your actions while recognizing your capacity for growth and change.

Ask yourself: *What judgments about myself am I still holding on to, and how might I begin separating those judgments from the choices I've made?*

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Sometimes, the first step toward feeling forgiven is choosing to speak to yourself with forgiveness, even when you aren't entirely convinced yet.

Expressing self-forgiveness doesn't mean pretending your mistakes didn't happen or forcing yourself to feel better. It means acknowledging what happened while giving yourself permission to learn, grow, and move forward.

You might begin with a simple statement: **I acknowledge what I did, and I accept responsibility for my choices. I am learning from this experience, and I am willing to give myself the opportunity to grow.**

You don't have to believe every word immediately. Self-forgiveness is something you can continue practicing as your feelings begin to change.

Ask yourself: *If I were ready to offer myself forgiveness, what would I want to say?*

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ACKNOWLEDGE YOUR FEELINGS | SET REALISTIC EXPECTATIONS | LET GO OF SELF-PUNISHMENT | RELEASE BLAME & RESENTMENT

Forgiving yourself is an important step toward rebuilding a healthier relationship with yourself, but trust and acceptance may take time to develop.

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Just as rebuilding trust with another person requires consistent effort, rebuilding trust in yourself involves following through on your commitments, practicing self-compassion, and recognizing the progress you make along the way.

You don't have to erase your past to create a different future. You can acknowledge your mistakes while learning to see yourself as someone worthy of patience, respect, and the opportunity to grow.

Remember: Reconciliation with yourself isn't about becoming the person you were before your mistakes. It's about developing a healthier relationship with the person you are becoming.

Ask yourself: *What is one small action I can take to begin rebuilding trust and strengthening my relationship with myself?*

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CONTINUE

Self-Acceptance: Learning to Set Healthy Boundaries

Self-acceptance means recognizing and accepting yourself as a whole person, including your strengths, limitations, imperfections, and experiences.

It doesn't mean you have to like everything about yourself or stop working toward personal growth. Instead, it means understanding that your worth isn't dependent on meeting certain expectations or becoming someone different.

An important part of self-acceptance is recognizing that **your needs, feelings, and limits matter, too.**

Setting healthy boundaries allows you to honor those needs while respecting the rights and autonomy of others. Boundaries aren't about controlling other people's

behavior; they're about identifying what is acceptable to you and deciding how you will respond when your limits are challenged.

Understanding Boundaries, Requests, and Control

Healthy boundaries help us communicate our needs, protect our well-being, and maintain respectful relationships. However, setting a boundary isn't the same thing as making a request or trying to control someone else's behavior.

Understanding the different can help us communicate more effectively.

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REQUEST | BOUNDARY | CONTROL

Asking Someone to do Something

A request communicates something you would like another person to do. It gives them the opportunity to consider your needs while respecting their freedom to agree or decline.

Requests can be an important part of healthy communication, but they don't guarantee that someone will respond the way you hope.

Example: "Would you mind calling me earlier in the evening? I usually go to bed around 9pm."

Remember: You can ask someone to change their behavior without assuming you have the right to control their choices.

REQUEST | BOUNDARY | CONTROL

Identifying Your Limits and Responses
A boundary identifies your personal limits and communicates how you will respond when those limits are challenged.

Healthy boundaries focus on **your own choices and behaviors,** rather than trying to force someone else to change. They help you protect your time, energy, emotional well-being, and personal values.

Boundaries don't have to be harsh or confrontational. You can communicate a limit clearly while remaining respectful of another person's autonomy.
Example: "I silence my phone at 9pm. If you call after that, I'll get back to you in the morning."

Remember: You cannot always control how others respond to your boundaries, but you can decide how you will honor them.

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REQUEST | BOUNDARY | CONTROL

Attempting to Manage Someone Else's Choices
Controlling behavior occurs when someone attempts to dictate another person's choices rather than respecting their autonomy.

Unlike healthy boundaries, controlling behavior focuses on **making someone else comply**. It may involve demands, threats, guilt, manipulation, or punishment.

It's important to recognize that controlling behavior can sometimes be disguised as boundary-setting. Simply calling something a boundary doesn't automatically make it healthy.
Example: "You're not allowed to call anyone after 9pm because I don't like it."

Remember: Healthy boundaries establish limits on your own participation or behavior. They don't give you authority over another person's decisions.

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The Key Difference

Requests communicate what we'd like. Boundaries communicate our limits and choices. Controlling behavior attempts to take away someone else's ability to choose.

Healthy boundaries respect **both your autonomy and the autonomy of others.**

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A friend frequently calls you late at night, even though you've explained that you need to get up early for work.
Which statement demonstrates a healthy personal boundary?

- ○ "You need to stop calling me after 9pm. It's disrespectful."
- ○ "Would you mind calling me earlier in the evening?"
- ○ "I turn my phone on Do Not Disturb at 9pm. If you call after that, I'll respond in the morning."
- ○ "If you call me after 9pm again, I'm never speaking to you."

SUBMIT

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Your coworker regularly asks you to cover their shifts. You've helped several times, but you're beginning to feel overwhelmed.
Which response communicates a healthy boundary while respecting your coworker's autonomy?

- "You need to stop asking me to cover your shifts."
- "I can't cover any additional shifts this month. You'll need to make other arrangements."
- "I guess I'll cover it, but you owe me."
- "If you were a better coworker, you wouldn't keep asking."

SUBMIT

You've told a family member that you aren't comfortable discussing your finances. During a family gathering, they bring up the subject again.
Which response best demonstrates maintaining a healthy bounadary?

- "I'm not discussing my finances. If the conversation continues, I'm going to step away."

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- ○ "I've already told you not to ask me about money. Why can't you respect that?"
- ○ "Fine, I'll tell you, but only because you won't leave me alone."
- ○ "If you bring up money again, you're not invited to any more family gatherings."

SUBMIT

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Personal Reflection: Honoring Your Own Boundaries

Setting healthy boundaries is one way of demonstrating self-acceptance. When you recognize that your needs, feelings, and limits matter, you begin treating yourself with the same respect you extend to others.

Boundaries aren't about keeping people out of your life. They're about creating healthier ways to participate in relationships while remaining true to yourself.

Take a moment to reflect:

1. Is there an area of your life where you frequently ignore your own needs or limits to accommodate others?
2. What personal boundary might help you create a healthier balance in that situation?

3. How could you communicate that boundary clearly and respectfully?
4. What might make maintaining this boundary difficult, and how could you prepare for that challenge?

Remember: Setting boundaries doesn't make you selfish. It means recognizing that your well-being deserves consideration, too.

You can respect and care for others without abandoning yourself in the process.

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CONTINUE

Self-Compassion: Learning to Treat Yourself with Kindness

Self-compassion means treating yourself with kindness, understanding, and patience, especially when you're struggling, experiencing setbacks, or facing difficult emotions.

We often extend compassion to others more readily than we offer it to ourselves. We recognize when someone else needs encouragement, forgiveness, or rest, yet criticize ourselves for needing those same things.

Practicing self-compassion doesn't mean avoiding responsibility, making excuses, or ignoring opportunities for growth. It means recognizing that **you deserve care and understanding even when life is difficult or you fall short of your expectations**.

One important way to practice self-compassion is through self-care. By recognizing and responding to our physical, emotional, social, and other wellness needs, we begin

treating ourselves with the same consideration we would offer someone we care about.

Understanding Self-Care

Self-care involves intentionally recognizing and responding to your needs in ways that support your overall well-being.

Although self-care is often associated with relaxation, hobbies, or treating yourself, it also includes everyday responsibilities and sometimes uncomfortable decisions.

Getting enough sleep, attending medical appointments, asking for help, maintaining boundaries, and addressing problems you've been avoiding can all be forms of self-care.

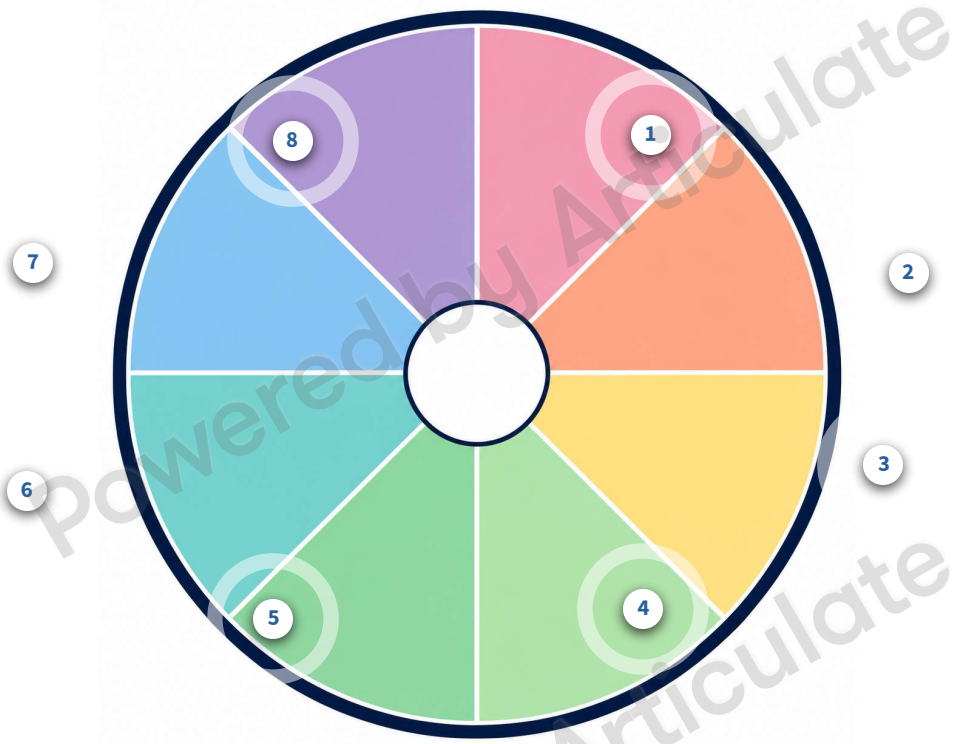
Self-care isn't always about doing what feels good in the moment. Sometimes it's about doing what supports your well-being in the long term.

Because our needs extend beyond physical health, effective self-care involves paying attention to multiple areas of wellness.

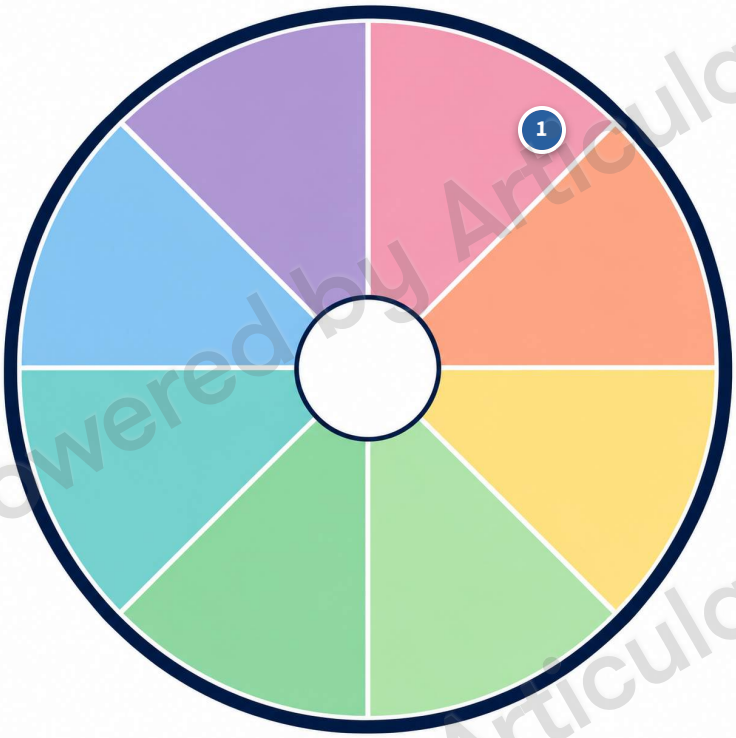
The Eight Dimensions of Wellness

Select each numbered marker on the wheel to explore the eight dimensions of wellness and discover how each contributes to your overall well-being.

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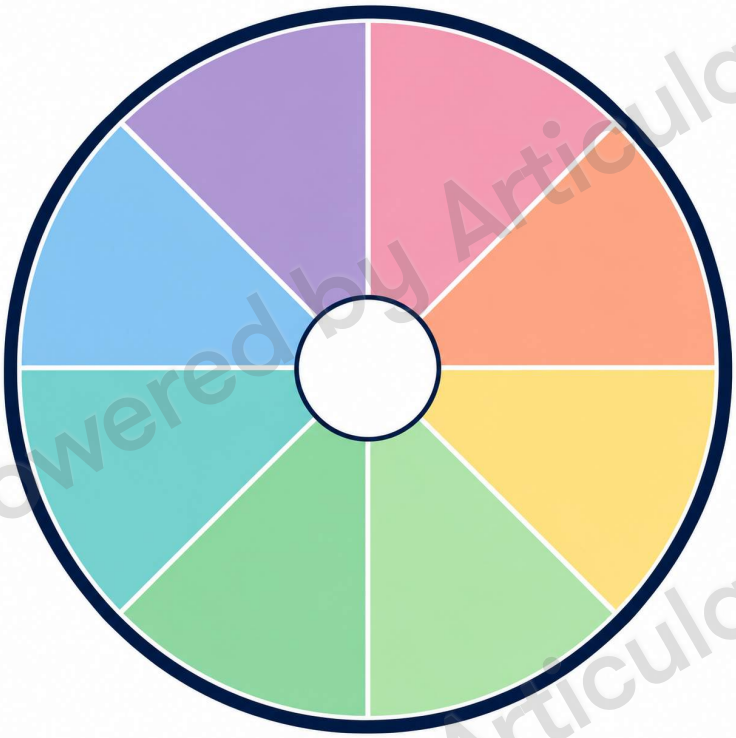
Social Wellness

Social wellness involves building and maintaining meaningful relationships, supportive connections, and a sense of belonging.

It includes communicating effectively, developing healthy relationships, maintaining boundaries, and knowing when to seek or offer support.

Examples: Spending time with loved ones, connecting with friends, participating in community activities, and asking for help when needed.

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Physical Wellness

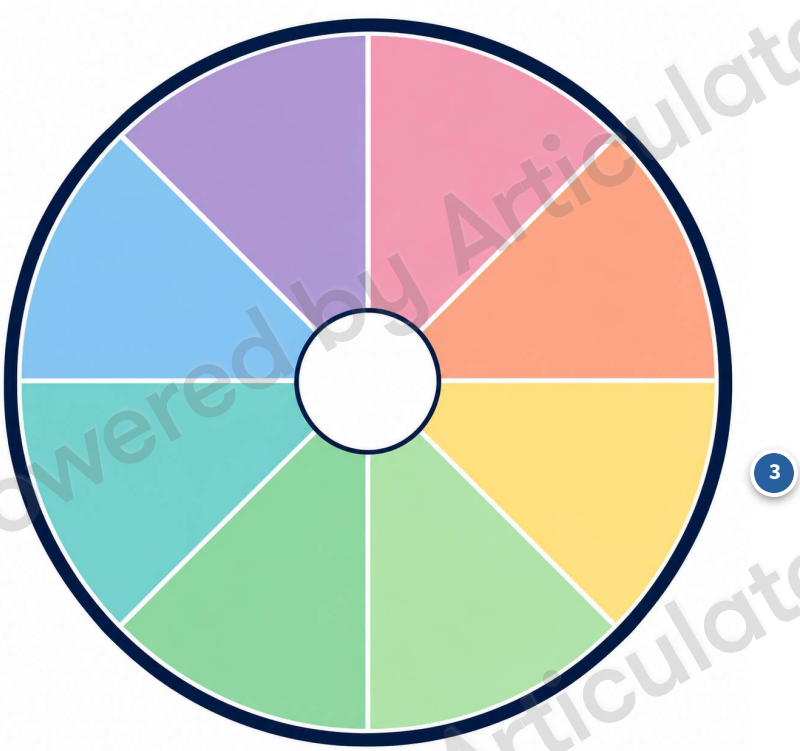
Physical wellness involves caring for your body and developing habits that support your overall health and daily functioning.

It includes getting adequate sleep, eating nutritious foods, engaging in physical activity, attending medical appointments, and responding to your body's needs.

Examples: Establishing a consistent sleep routine, finding enjoyable ways to move your body, staying hydrated, and seeking medical care when needed.

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Intellectual Wellness

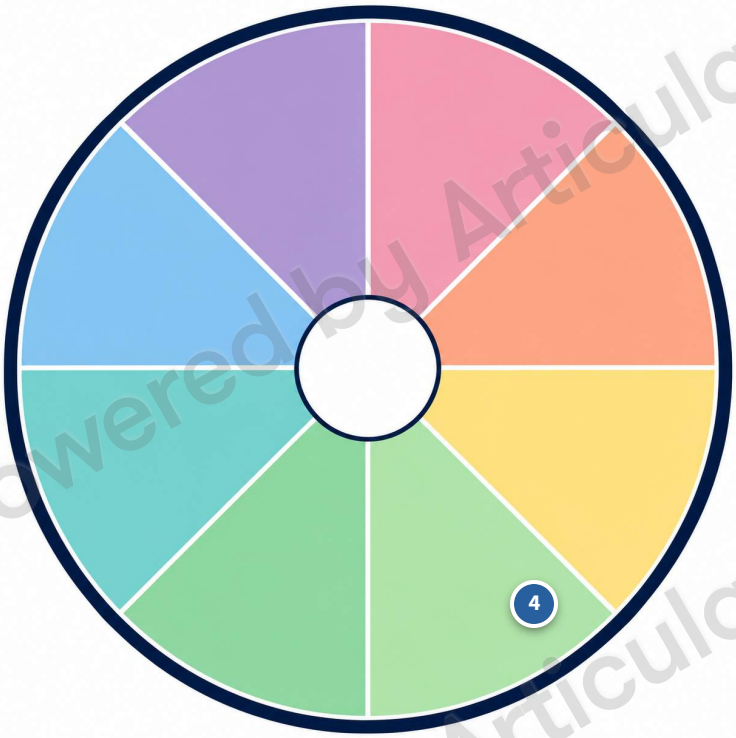
Intellectual wellness involves keeping your mind active, exploring new ideas, and engaging in opportunities for learning, creativity, and personal growth.

It includes developing new skills, thinking critically, pursuing interests, and remaining curious about the world around you.

Examples: Reading, learning a new skill, solving puzzles, engaging in creative activities, and exploring unfamiliar subjects.

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Emotional Wellness

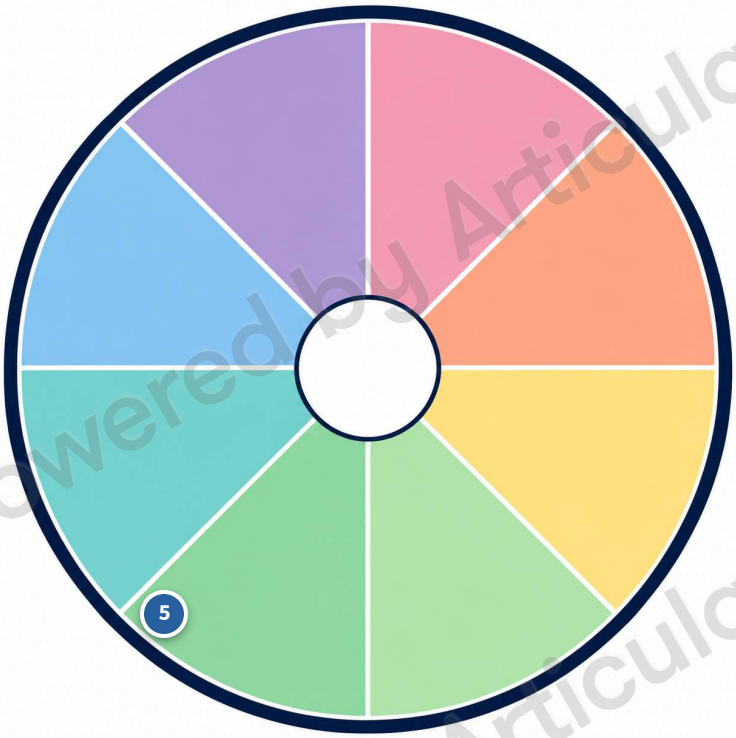
Emotional wellness involves recognizing, understanding, and managing your emotions in healthy ways.

It includes developing emotional awareness, coping with stress, expressing feelings appropriately, and responding to life's challenges with flexibility and resilience.
Emotional wellness doesn't mean feeling happy all the time. It means allowing yourself to experience a range of emotions while developing healthy ways to respond to them.

Examples: Identifying your feelings, practicing healthy coping strategies, seeking emotional support, and allowing yourself time to process difficult experiences.

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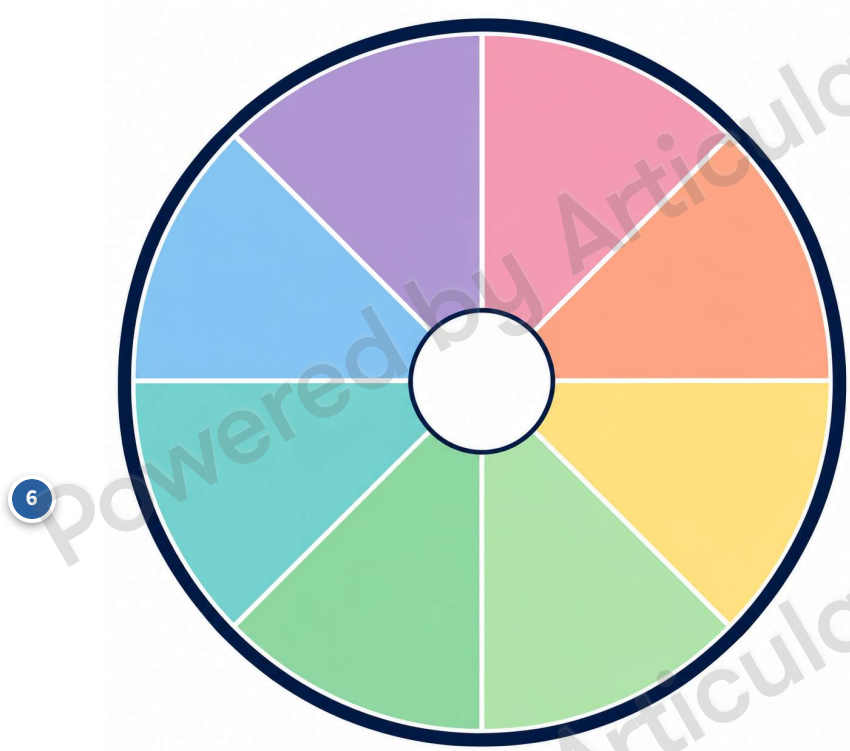
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Spiritual Wellness

Spiritual wellness involves developing a sense of meaning, purpose, and connection to something beyond yourself.

It includes exploring your personal values, beliefs, and sense of purpose. Spiritual wellness may involve religious faith or practices, but it doesn't require belonging to a particular religion or holding religious beliefs.

Examples: Prayer, meditation, spending time in nature, reflecting on personal values, participating in meaningful traditions, and engaging in activities that provide a sense of purpose.



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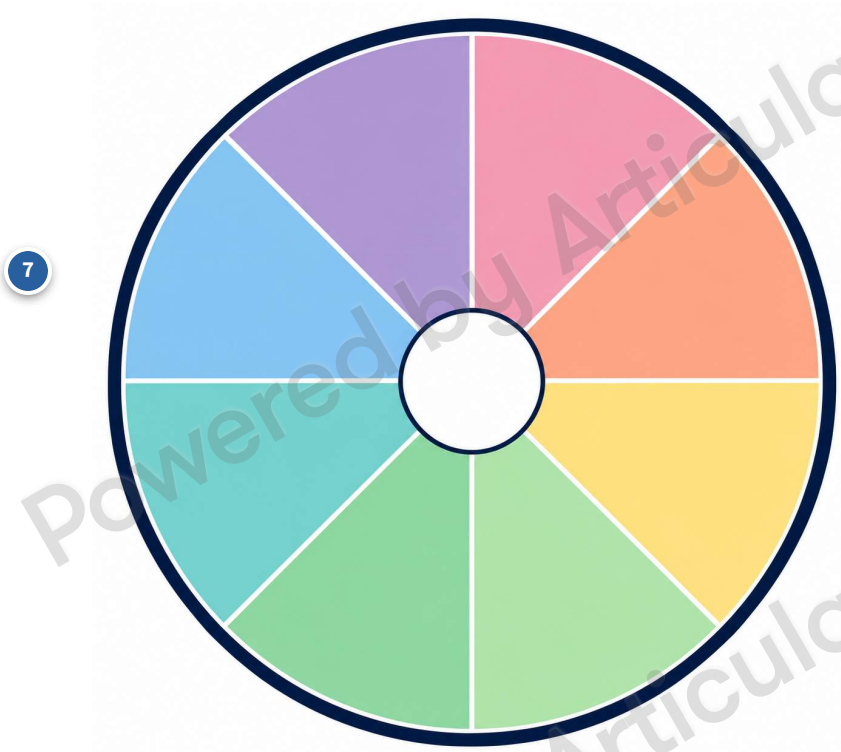
Occupational Wellness

Occupational wellness involves finding satisfaction, purpose, and balance in the work and responsibilities that occupy your time.

It includes recognizing your strengths, developing skills, maintaining healthy boundaries, and engaging in activities that provide a sense of accomplishment.

Occupational wellness isn't limited to paid employment. Volunteering, caregiving, education, and other meaningful responsibilities can also contribute to this dimension.

Examples: Pursuing professional development, setting work-life boundaries, volunteering, exploring career interests, and finding meaning in daily responsibilities.



Financial Wellness

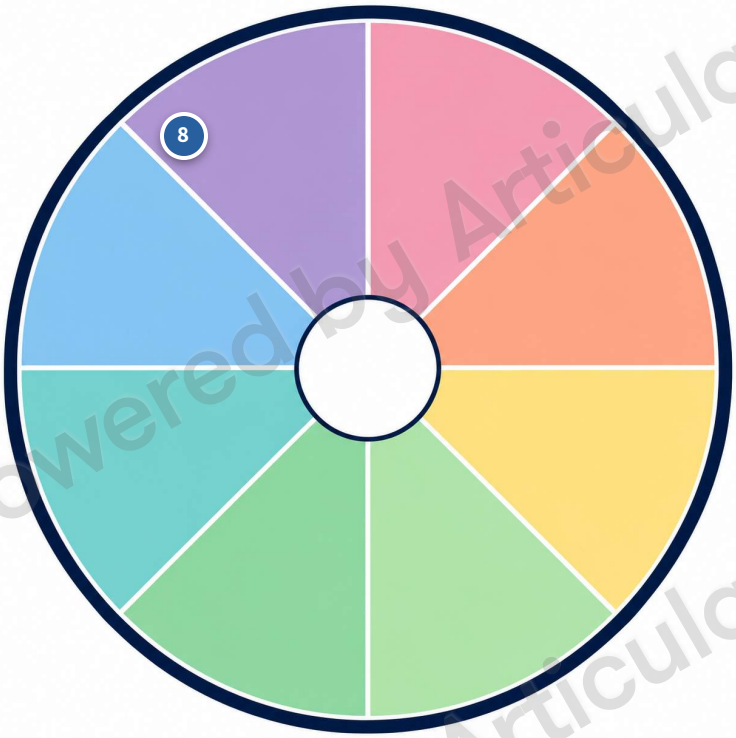
Financial wellness involves developing a healthy relationship with money and managing financial resources in ways that support your needs, goals, and overall well-being.

It includes understanding your financial situation, making informed decisions, planning for expenses, and managing financial stress.

Financial wellness doesn't mean being wealthy or debt-free. It means working toward financial stability and making choices that align with your circumstances and priorities.

Examples: Creating a realistic budget, tracking expenses, setting savings goals, understanding financial obligations, and seeking financial guidance when needed.

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Environmental Wellness

Environmental wellness involves creating and maintaining surroundings that support your physical, emotional, and overall well-being.

It includes recognizing how your living, working, and community environments affect you, making your spaces comfortable and functional, and developing a sense of safety and connection to your surroundings.

Environmental wellness also includes understanding how your choices affect the natural environment.

Examples: Organizing your living space, reducing clutter, spending time outdoors, creating a comfortable workspace, and participating in activities that protect the environment.

How Wobbly Is Your Wheel?

Wellness isn't about achieving perfect balance in every area of your life. It's about recognizing where you feel supported, where you may be struggling, and where you want to make changes.

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In this activity, you'll create two wellness wheels:

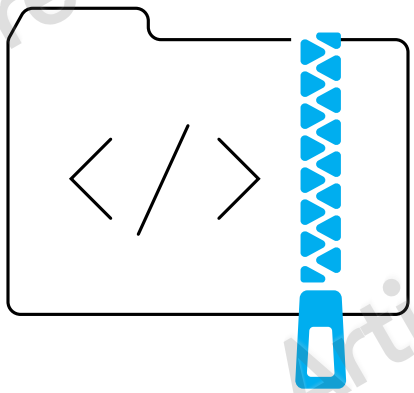
Satisfaction: How satisfied are you with each area of your life right now?

Effort: How much effort are you currently putting into each area?

You'll rate all eight dimensions on a scale of 1–10, then compare your completed wheels.

As you examine the results, consider where your satisfaction and effort align—and where they differ.

Here's the question: How far would you get if these represented wheels on a bicycle?



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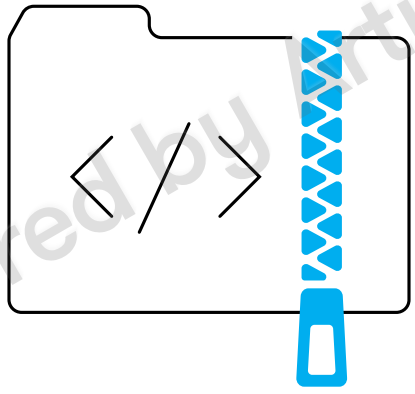
Creating Your Personal Self-Care Plan

Self-care doesn't have to involve dramatic changes or elaborate routines. Sometimes, the smallest adjustments can make a meaningful difference in how you feel and function.

Think back to your wellness wheels. Were there areas where your satisfaction was lower than you'd like? Were there areas where you were putting in considerable effort without feeling satisfied with the results?

Use what you've learned to create a self-care plan that reflects your needs, priorities, and current circumstances.

Remember: **Self-care isn't another obligation to add to your to-do list. It's an opportunity to support yourself in ways that matter to you.**



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Treat Yourself Like a Good Friend

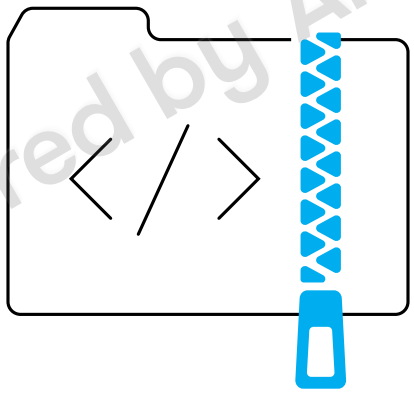
Think about how you respond when someone you care about is having a difficult time. You might offer encouragement, acknowledge their feelings, remind them of their strengths, or reassure them that making mistakes doesn't make them a failure.

Now think about how you respond to yourself in similar situations.

We often extend patience, understanding, and compassion to others while holding ourselves to much harsher standards.

Self-compassion means learning to offer yourself the same kindness and understanding you would offer someone you care about.

In the following activity, you'll explore the difference between how you speak to a friend and how you speak to yourself.



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Self-Love: Building a Lasting Relationship with Yourself

Self-love isn't about believing you're perfect, feeling confident every day, or never experiencing self-doubt. It's about developing a relationship with yourself that is grounded in respect, acceptance, compassion, and care.

Throughout this course, you've explored how your thoughts, beliefs, choices, and behaviors influence the way you see and treat yourself.

Self-love means putting that awareness into practice. It involves recognizing your worth, honoring your needs, celebrating your growth, and continuing to treat yourself with kindness—even when life gets difficult.

You won't always feel good about yourself, and that's okay. **Self-love isn't something you achieve once and never lose. It's something you can continue choosing and practicing.**

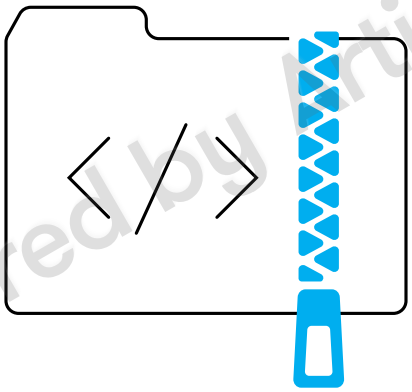
My Commitment to Myself

You've explored six stages of self-love, from recognizing harmful patterns to developing greater self-awareness, acceptance, and compassion.

Think about what you've learned along the way. Which ideas challenged you? Which activities helped you see yourself differently? What would you like to carry forward?

Your relationship with yourself will continue to grow and change. You don't need to have everything figured out to begin treating yourself with greater kindness and respect.

Your next step isn't to become a different person. It's to continue building a healthier relationship with the person you already are.



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Your Path Continues

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You've reached the end of this course, but your journey toward self-love doesn't end here.

Along the way, you've explored the beliefs that shape your self-image, practiced challenging unhelpful thoughts, considered the importance of forgiveness and boundaries, and developed strategies for caring for yourself with greater compassion.

Some of these practices may come naturally. Others may take time, patience, and repetition. There will be days when you feel confident in your progress and days when old patterns resurface.

Neither experience determines your worth.

You don't have to love every part of yourself to treat yourself with love. You don't have to feel confident to recognize your value. And you don't have to be perfect to deserve kindness, respect, and care.

The goal isn't to reach a place where you never struggle with self-love again. The goal is to develop the skills to return to it when you do.

Keep learning. Keep growing. Keep showing up for yourself.

You are worth the effort.

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